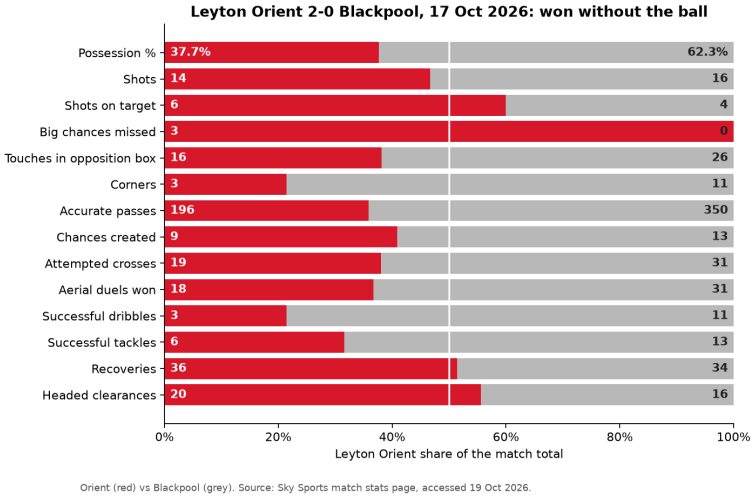
Leyton Orient: post-match and performance briefing

Prepared 19 Oct 2026 by Anthony Adusei-Poku (independent analysis from public data, not club data). League One table to 17 Oct 2026; match xG and shot data to 10 Oct 2026.

Key points

- **Blackpool (H) 2-0, 17 Oct:** won with 37.7% possession and 3 corners to 11, but 6 shots on target to 4 and 3 big chances missed to 0. Second clean sheet in a row after 0-0 at Bradford, where Bradford had no shots on target.
- **Table vs process:** 9th on 14 points (4W 2D 4L), but **23rd of 24 on xG difference** (-0.71 per game). Over the first 9 games Orient scored 13 from 8.2 xG and conceded 11 from 14.6 xG.
- **Biggest lever: shots on target conceded.** Orient face 4.56 a game (top-six average 3.41). League One history values closing that gap at about **+14 points a season**, more than matching top-six creation (+12).
- **Sustainability risk:** points are being held up by finishing (0.39 goals per shot on target) and saves (0.73 save rate), both above top-six averages. Across 215 League One team-seasons these rates barely carry over; shot-on-target share does.
- **Projection:** a Dixon-Coles model simulated 10,000 times gives a mean of 63 points, 10% chance of the top six and 4% of the bottom four. Next: Reading (A) Wed 21 Oct, the division's 2nd-best side by xG difference.

1. Post-match: Leyton Orient 2-0 Blackpool (Sat 17 Oct 2026)



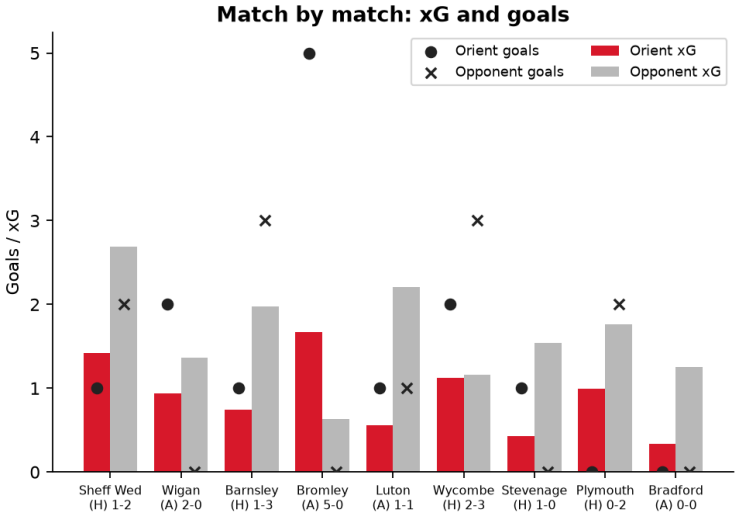
Orient (red) vs Blackpool (grey). Source: Sky Sports match stats page, accessed 19 Oct 2026.

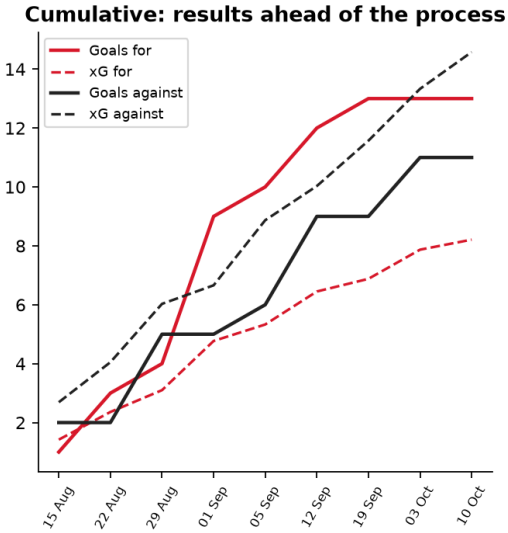
Goals: Forrester 31' (header, Gilbert cross), Scarlett 76' (pen). Att. 8,055.

- **Out of possession by design:** 271 passes attempted to 446; Blackpool had 26 touches in Orient's box to 16 and won 31 aerials to 18.
- **Efficient in transition:** 6 of 14 shots on target, 3 big chances missed, Olowu header off the bar before the penalty.
- **Watch-point:** 11 corners conceded here and 11 at Bradford. Orient concede 6.8 corners a game (20th) and win 3.7 (23rd), so set-piece defending is a high-volume task.
- **Box defending held:** 20 headed clearances; Forrester cleared Ashworth's header off the line.

2. Season so far: results ahead of the process

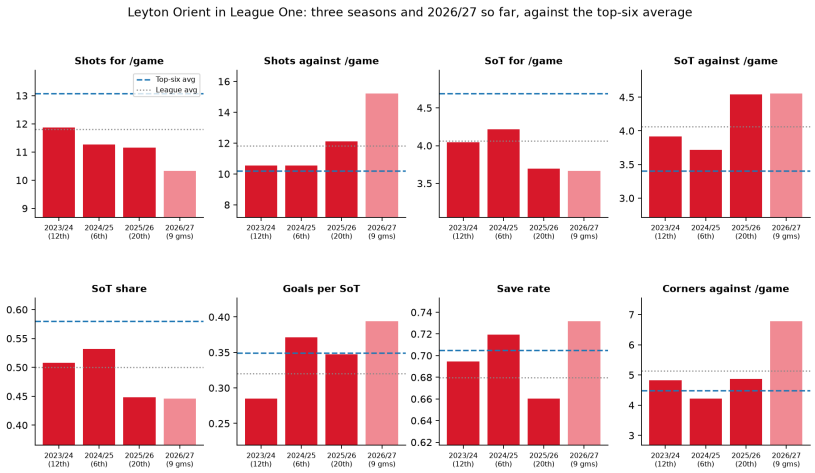
Leyton Orient 2026/27, League One matches to 10 Oct 2026 (xG: football-data.co.uk)



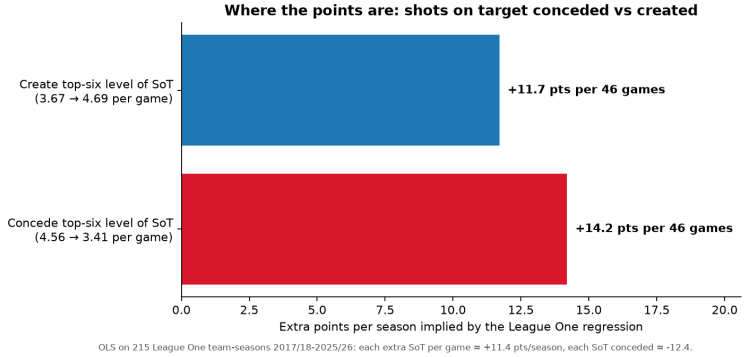


Away form is strong (4 games, 8 pts, 8-1); home form is not (6 games, 6 pts, 7-10). The 5-0 at Bromley (1.67 xG) supplies 4 of the 13 goals in the xG sample. Orient take 10.3 shots a game (22nd) at 0.088 xG per shot (league 0.104) and face 15.2 (19th).

3. What drives League One points, and where Orient stand



- **2024/25 (6th, 78 pts):** SoT share 53%, finishing 0.37 goals per SoT.
- **2025/26 (20th, 52 pts):** SoT share fell to 45%; SoT conceded rose to 4.5 a game; save rate 0.66.
- **2026/27 (9 games):** SoT share 45%, shots against 15.2 a game (top-six avg 10.2).
- Game state: in 2025/26 Orient took 0.87 pts per game from 23 matches level at half-time (league avg 1.32), roughly 10 points lost.

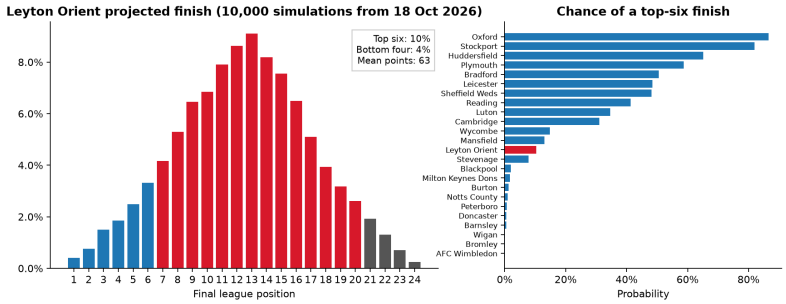


Regression on 215 League One team-seasons (2017/18-2025/26): each extra shot on target per game is worth about **+11.4 points a season**, each one conceded about **-12.4** (R^2 0.67). On current rates it expects 1.14 points per game (52 over 46).

What to trust early: over the first 9 games, shot and shot-on-target shares correlate about 0.49 with points over the rest of a season, and 0.47-0.51 from one season to the next. Finishing (0.20; 0.08 year to year) and save rate (0.10; 0.16) are mostly noise.

4. Next three fixtures and season outlook

Date	Fixture	Orient win	Draw	Orient loss	Opp. xGD rank	Opponent profile (2026/27 to 10 Oct)
21 Oct	Reading v Orient	26%	24%	50%	2 of 24	2.05 xG for, 0.97 against per game; 16.6 shots a game
24 Oct	Burton v Orient	36%	27%	37%	22 of 24	0.83 xG for, 1.51 against; 10.1 shots a game
31 Oct	Orient v Cambridge	40%	28%	32%	18 of 24	1.13 xG for, 1.42 against; 7.0 corners won a game



- Projected points 63 (80% range 53-72); median finish 13th (80% range 6th-18th).
- Top six 10%; automatic promotion 1%; bottom four 4%.
- The model uses scores only (rates Orient 14th); on xG they rank 23rd, so this outlook is if anything generous.
- Validated out of sample on all 552 League One 2025/26 matches: RPS 0.2184 vs 0.2280 for base rates and 0.2097 for the closing market.

Data and limits. Results, shots, corners, odds and match xG: football-data.co.uk (free CSVs; the provider of the new 2026/27 xG column is not documented, so xG is treated as indicative, and it tracks shots on target with r = 0.64). Orient v Blackpool stats: Sky Sports match page. Results 15-17 Oct: Football Web Pages. No shot locations, set-piece tags or player data are freely available for League One, so set pieces are measured by corner volume only. Nine or ten matches is a small sample. Full method and code: github.com/anthony07-max/leyton-orient-analysis